



The People of South America

the Inuit, First Nations, and American Indian peoples, they wandered across the spectacularly varied landscape they discovered, and eventually inhabited almost every part of it.

HIGHLAND PEOPLE

These Andean shepherds in Bolivia belong to the large Aymara Amerindian group. This people—and their language, which is also called Aymara—live mainly in the highlands of Bolivia, Chile, and Peru.



Clearly of African descent, this mother and child are Maroons from Suriname.

AFRICAN ORIGINS

When the European colonizers arrived (see opposite), they built huge plantations and brought over millions of slaves from Africa to work on them. In many parts of South America, particularly in the northeast, descendants of these slaves survive in large numbers.

THIS LONG, VAGUELY TRIANGULAR continent was first settled thousands of years ago by adventurous migrants from North America.

Descended from the same prehistoric race as

SPACE-AGE CITY



While many South American cities have a historical look, Brasilia, the capital of Brazil, is a strikingly modern metropolis. Here, a tiny human figure enhances the monumental proportions of the city's Congress and Senate Building, designed by Brazilian architects Oscar Niemeyer and Lucio Costa.

FIGHTING FOR THEIR HOME

The number of people living in isolation from the industrial world is dwindling rapidly. Many of those who are left make their home in the vast Amazon rain forest, which is under serious threat from developers who cut down its trees and plunder the region's natural resources.

This Matsigenka Indian boy lives in a small village near the Galvez River in Peru.

